Scratch Cat Duo

Studio 87. Free and open source (AGPL-3.0-or-later).

Intro

Scratch Cat Duo is two DJ decks and a mixer inside one plugin. Load a track on each deck (it is analysed for BPM, beat grid and key), or send a DAW track to a deck and scratch the last minute of it. Use it to scratch, mix and loop your own songs while you compose, or to play a set from your DAW.

Quick start

- Click the track name box on a deck (or use the track browser at the bottom, or drop a file) and pick a file (wav, aiff, flac, ogg or mp3). The BPM and the key (Camelot code and name) appear next to the deck name.
- Press PLAY. Drag the platter to scratch: the sound follows your hand, forward and backward, and holds when you stop.
- Move the crossfader between the decks. Sync matches the deck tempo to the DAW tempo (or to the other deck when Tempo is set to Decks lead).
- The two waveforms at the top show both decks on one time axis, so when the beat lines match the beats are aligned.

Deck

- Source: File plays the loaded track. DAW input plays the audio that arrives on the plugin input for that deck; the last minute is kept so you can scratch it. Go live returns to the live sound.
- CUE: while playing it jumps back to the cue point and stops. While stopped it sets the cue point here; hold it on the cue point to preview.
- Sync, Key lock and Quant. Key lock changes the tempo without changing the pitch. Quant snaps cue points, hot cues and loops to the beat grid.
- Tempo fader with a range of 8, 16 or 50 %. Up is faster, down is slower. Double click to reset.
- Loop in, Loop out and Exit, and beat loops of 1/4 to 8 beats from the playhead.
- Brake slows to a stop. Backspin spins backward and stops. Roll, Censor, Stutter and Trans work while you hold them; Roll and Censor keep the track running underneath and jump back in time when released.
- Eight hot cue pads: an empty pad sets a cue at the playhead, a set pad jumps there, right click clears it.

Mixer

- Trim, three band EQ (High, Mid, Low; all the way down kills the band), Colour filter (left is a low pass, right is a high pass, centre is off), CUE for the headphone output, and the channel fader.
- Crossfader with three curves: Smooth (linear), Sharp (both decks at full level, then a quick cut near each end) and Const (constant power).
- The master level, and the safety soft clip that only acts above 0.95.

FX chain

- Three effect slots in series: Filter, Echo, Reverb, Flanger or Crush, each with an On switch, an Amount and a Dry/Wet. Apply the chain to Deck A, Deck B, A + B or the master. Chain mix scales every slot. Echo time is set in beats and follows the tempo.

DAW routing and MIDI

- Deck A in and Deck B in are the plugin inputs. Enable the extra inputs and outputs in your host to route DAW tracks in and each deck out to its own channel. Outputs set to A, B and Master gives each deck its own stereo output next to the master.
- Cue output: the channels with CUE on, mixed with the master by the Cue mix knob.
- Tempo: Follow DAW uses the host tempo for Sync and for the echo; Decks lead uses the other deck.

- MIDI learn: pick a control in the list, press Learn, then move or press the control on your controller. Jog wheel mapping is relative; set its sensitivity in the gear menu. Mappings are saved with the project. Built-in maps for specific controllers are planned.

Window

- Resize by dragging any edge or corner; the 100% button returns to the normal size.
- Hover a control to see an info bubble. Turn them off in the gear menu.
- Free and open source. The plugin collects no data and never touches the network.